

Places to visit

MISSOURI BOTANICAL GARDEN, ST. LOUIS, MISSOURI

Features a variety of themed gardens, including the largest Japanese garden in North America, plus the Climatron, the world's first geodesic dome greenhouse.

NEW ORLEANS BOTANICAL GARDEN, NEW ORLEANS, LOUISIANA

An Art Deco botanical garden focusing on the plants of the Gulf South.

DESERT BOTANICAL GARDEN, PHOENIX, ARIZONA

Plants of the desert are the centerpiece here. Visit Plants and People of the Sonoran Trail, where visitors can twist agave fibers into twine, and four other trails.

NEW YORK BOTANICAL GARDEN, BRONX, NEW YORK

Features a Victorian-era greenhouse, the Enid A. Haupt Conservatory, and a children's garden.

ORNAMENTAL BUNCHES

A bouquet of flowers doesn't have to fade away. Its beauty can be preserved by taking it out of water and keeping it in a safe place until each stem has dried out. Tie the bouquet with a ribbon and display it in a vase or on the wall.



This bunch of dried flowers was purchased at a flower market



WOODLAND WALKS

There are many official countryside walks that choose specific routes best suited to the time of year. The organized walk below follows a path that takes ramblers through the first colorful crop of springtime bluebells.



IN YOUR OWN BACKYARD

If you have a yard, this is the best place to find out more about plants. Using a notebook, you can log the growth and development of various species through the seasons. You can also grow your own plants.

ROOM WITH A VIEW

If you don't have access to a yard, window boxes make very rewarding miniature gardens. Flowers and herbs can be grown in any container and placed on a window ledge. Another way to grow plants outside is to cut an opening in a large bag of compost and use it as a soil bed.



Sunflower seeds ideally should be planted in May

USEFUL WEBSITES

- The USDA's extensive PLANTS Database:
www.plants.usda.gov
- Homepage of the Lady Bird Johnson Wildflower Center, featuring a native plant database:
www.wildflower.org
- A kid-friendly look at how plants work:
www.biology4kids.com/files/plants_main.html
- An introduction to plant biology from the Missouri Botanical Garden:
www.mbgnet.net/bioplants/